

Epilogue

When my wife, Liz, was a teenager, her father would drag her along to a weekend market, where they had a stall selling vintage clothes. It was a father–daughter ritual that taught her the value of buying, selling and making a profit. Okay, and it was also a pretty good excuse for father–daughter time, too.

Liz’s father tragically died just after her final year of high school.

He never got to see his only daughter become an adult.

Never got to hug her goodbye at the family doorstep.

So what became of her?

Well, I met Liz when she was 24, and working as a TV producer on *The Project*.

I quickly realised she wasn’t like many 20-something kids.

She already owned her own inner-city apartment, and her own car, and had money in the bank.

No man was part of her plan. There was no inheritance. Just grit, determination and money smarts.

I never got to meet my father-in-law, but I know he’d be immensely proud of the woman Liz has become.

And I believe looking back at those weekends would have given him a deep sense of satisfaction and peace.

After all, our duty as parents—the reason we’re here—is to provide for our kids and to prepare them.

That’s what Liz’s father did.